

COVID-19 Maternal Immunization Tracker (COMIT)

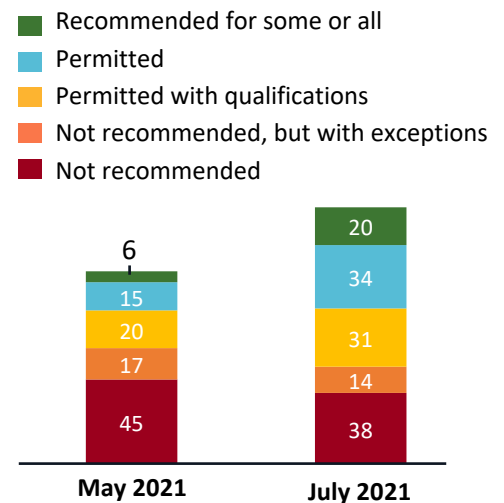
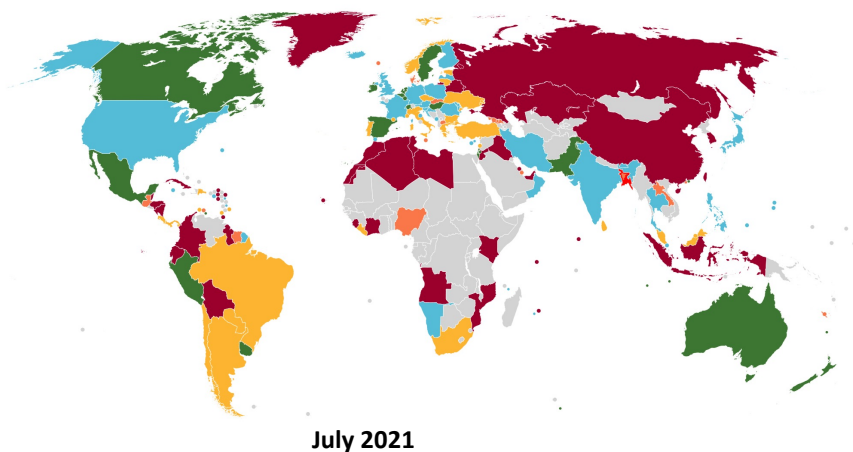
COVID-19 vaccine policies for pregnant and lactating people worldwide

July 2021

Overview

COMIT is a new resource for the global health community that provides a snapshot of national COVID-19 vaccination policies for pregnant and lactating people worldwide. Through maps, tables, and country profiles, COMIT offers up-to-date information on evolving vaccination policies and recommendations as 222 countries and territories respond to the dynamic pandemic and emerging evidence on vaccines.

More countries and territories are recommending COVID-19 vaccination for pregnant and lactating people.



However, policies continue to vary widely among countries.

20 countries/territories

have an explicit recommendation that some or all pregnant people should receive vaccination. Of these, Mexico, Peru, and Pakistan are the only non-high-income countries to recommend COVID-19 vaccination for pregnant women.

38 countries/territories

have policies noting that people who are pregnant should not receive the vaccine or that the vaccine is contraindicated in pregnancy.

54 countries/territories

have policies either permitting or recommending Covid-19 vaccines to pregnant persons, or 33 more than in May 2021.

World Health Organization has issued guidance on COVID-19 vaccines



WHO guidance permits the use in pregnant and lactating women of all COVID-19 vaccines for which it has issued interim recommendations.

These six vaccines include:

- Johnson & Johnson/Janssen
- Moderna
- Oxford-AstraZeneca
- Pfizer/BioNTech
- Sinopharm
- Sinovac

Countries face unique circumstances and consider a variety of factors when determining COVID-19 vaccination policies for pregnant and lactating people.



Israel recommends COVID-19 vaccine for pregnant women

Following the deaths of pregnant women from COVID-19 in early 2021, Israel started recommending the Pfizer and BioNTech COVID-19 vaccine for pregnant and breastfeeding women in February 2021. Multiple factors are associated with the country's success in vaccinating pregnant women, including its small size, relatively young population, centralized national government system, strong logistics capacity, and rapid mobilization of special government funding.

Link: [Guidance statement from the Ministry of Health](#)



Brazil permits use of Pfizer and Sinovac vaccines in pregnant women with high risk

On May 11, Brazil suspended its national COVID-19 vaccination of pregnant and lactating women following the death of a 35-year-old pregnant woman from a hemorrhagic stroke, possibly related to vaccination. Brazil now permits vaccination of pregnant persons at high risk of infection or serious disease from COVID-19 with the Pfizer and Sinovac vaccines, but not with the AstraZeneca vaccine.

Link: [Guidance statement from regulator ANVISA](#)



India expanding vaccination to pregnant and lactating persons

In early June, India expanded its vaccination campaign, permitting lactating persons to receive a COVID-19 vaccine. This was further expanded in early July when the Ministry of Health and Family Welfare announced pregnant persons could be offered COVID-19 vaccines, reversing their previous position of "Not recommended".

Link: [Operational Guidance for COVID-19 Vaccination of Pregnant Women](#)



South Africa permits vaccination of pregnant women with co-morbidities or at high risk of exposure

On April 29, South Africa issued guidance that pregnant women at high risk of exposure to COVID-19 or who have comorbidities that add to their risk of severe COVID-19 disease may be vaccinated in consultation with their health care provider.

Link: [Guidance statement from South African Health Products Regulatory Authority](#)

Excerpts from country vaccination guidance

Based on the findings of the preclinical phases of research, in animal models ... and of the monitoring platforms of pregnant and vaccinated women against COVID-19 (V-Safe and VAERS in the USA), it is considered that the benefits of vaccination for pregnant women outweigh the possible risks - real or theoretical - of vaccination in this population group, so people who are pregnant will be vaccinated against the SARS-CoV-2 virus."

May 11, 2021

Government of Mexico

[National Policy for Vaccination Against the SARS-CoV-2 Virus](#)

While there is no evidence to suggest the Pfizer/BioNTech, and Moderna vaccines are unsafe for pregnant or breastfeeding women, there is currently insufficient clinical evidence to confirm their safety. However, the decision to vaccinate these individuals is made on case-by-case basis. The physician will decide if the benefit of vaccinating the woman outweighs the potential vaccine risks i.e. if the woman is having a healthy pregnancy with no high risk of exposure, it is recommended to postpone the vaccination.

Qatar Ministry of Public Health

[Vaccine FAQs](#)

It should be noted that vaccination is not recommended for pregnant women.

January 15, 2021

Angola Ministry of Health

[National Vaccination Plan for COVID-19](#)

For more information and real-time policy tracking, please visit COMIT at www.comitglobal.org